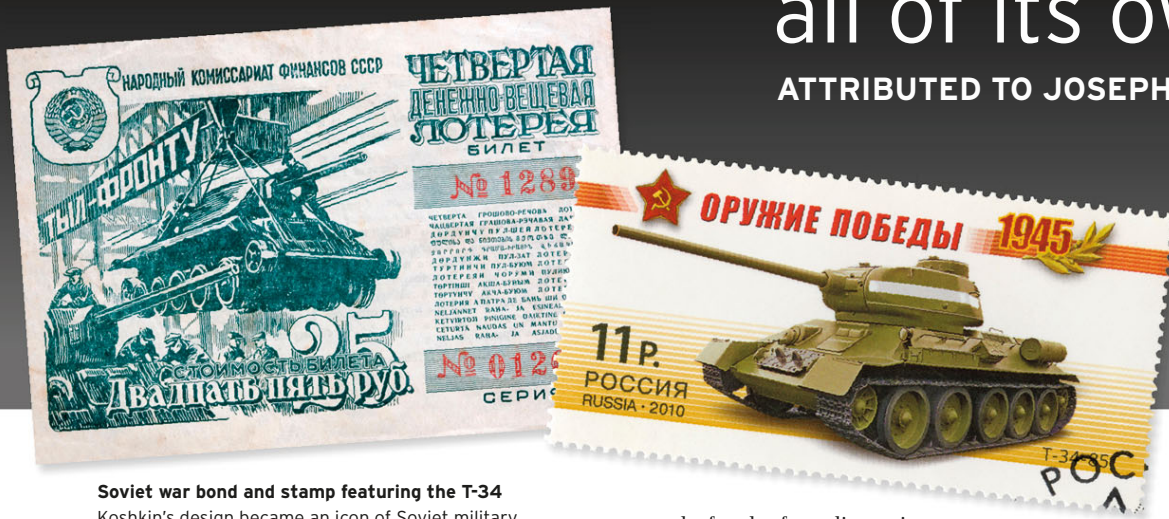


“Quantity has a quality all of its own.”

ATTRIBUTED TO JOSEPH STALIN



Soviet war bond and stamp featuring the T-34

Koshkin's design became an icon of Soviet military supremacy. Koshkin himself received various state honors posthumously, the last of them in 1990.

of tanks in battle, but also the need to move factories to relative safety behind the Ural Mountains. New and simplified production methods became a necessity—workers produced

tanks for the front line using the most basic of factory facilities.

Production costs went down, speed of manufacture increased, and a staggering 112,000 tanks of different types were made between 1940 and 1945.

Koshkin himself died after contracting pneumonia while on a lengthy cross-country test-drive of the T-34 prototypes, and although

his contributions were only formally acknowledged years after his death, his T-34 was vital in the eventual defeat of Germany.

Soviet tank factory

Workers assemble an IS-2 heavy tank in 1943. The IS-2's design was a deliberate move to a heavier gun than Koshkin's T-34, whose effectiveness had spurred the arms race in tank design between Germany and the Soviet Union.

